

whatweretheythinking.com

That '70s Show!

The late '70s and early '80s were a tumultuous time and one when not many knew what was happening. This fact is also reflected in "The Past Passes By".

This, of course, we're guessing, is the title of this site, since 'Crystal Machine info' is the title of the page.

"In 1971 Tim Blake met the French Light show artiste

PATRICE WARRENER.

When Tim left GONG in 1975, they formed the

"CRYSTAL MACHINE".

Who these folks are is explained in the text that follows: they were "The first group in the world dedicated to electronic

music and light show, featuring, Lasers, for the first time ever". Our point of concentration, though, is their site, which is as colourful as their shows perhaps were. With each line of text in a different colour, it's indeed a visit back in time to the days of Web page design in the early '90s and the spirit of the '80s.

Some of the group's achievements include shows in Spain, Japan, Holland and Gladstonbury Festival. For some reason, we decided we should Google that

last, and it turned out they'd actually performed at the *Glastonbury* festival—although there does exist a Gladstonbury festival too!

Did we mention the blue background on which a fuzzy, blurred, pink-tinged photograph is placed? That is the only visual relief on this entire page. There are all of three links—one of which displays no text—and these lead to some photos. Very 1976! Let's just keep it in its time—accept our apologies for bringing this site to your notice!



who encounter splogs. Search results have been dramatically affected, especially on services such as Technorati's, which focus on blog tracking. "It's the #1 problem for search engines," says Matt Mullenweg of WordPress, a blog-software service.

The first way to make money off splogs is this: find a topic—say Servers—that draws consumers who may be valuable to advertisers on big search engines. Then, register for the programs that let those search companies place ads on the blog.

Next, set up a blog that takes in news items via feeds about that subject. If all goes well, the search engines will identify your blog as a prime place for ads. Now all you need to do is find (and pay peanuts to) someone who'll keep clicking the ads!

Programmes such as Google's AdSense pay out each time someone responds to an ad, so a splogger could make big money this way.

The second form of splogging involves creating a fake blog filled with links to other sites. People using a search engine to find a blog on, say, breast cancer, would get to a site full of ads for, and links to, porn sites.

And third, you could use blogs' feedback fields. Sploggers can post totally off-topic comments, including a sales pitch.

Jason Goldman, Product Manager for the Blogger division of Google says they've tightened up the blog-creating process—Google now offers a quick way to report bogus pages so they can be blocked from the search engine.

Other blog hosts and search engines are fighting splogs. Goldman admits that like with spam, splogging could take on the "arms-race" aspect, with the baddies always trying to be one step ahead. Well, we've got used to spam—and if you read blogs, you'd get used to splogging as well. ■

Compiled by Aditya Kubler,
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Blog WATCH

This time round our selection is all about the IIPM blog controversy, which began with a story written by Rashmi Bansal in the *JAM* magazine

India Uncut

<http://indiauncut.blogspot.com/2005/10/question-of-principles.html>

A Question Of Principles

A few months ago Jam Magazine, edited by Rashmi Bansal, did a story exposing some of the claims made by IIPM, the educational institute run by Arindam Chaudhuri. After that happened, some of the IIPM staff barged into the Jam office. They "did not offer any new or material facts, other than argument." Then Rashmi got a legal notice from them.

A number of blogs sprung up overnight defending IIPM and defaming Rashmi and Gaurav Sabnis, a popular blogger who had linked to Rashmi's article...

Desipundit.com

www.desipundit.com/2005/10/08/lies-damned-lies-and-fake-blogs/

IIPM Blog Wars Redux

This time it is personal. Rashmi Bansal has been attacked by so-called IIPM graduates. Gaurav has been served a legal notice (via e-mail) asking him to retract his statements against IIPM. Couple of days later, another blogger Varna got an identical legal notice from IIPM. More importantly, this attempted suppression of freedom of speech shall not be tolerated. Kaps has issued a call to join the fight against IIPM. Bloggers all around the world have responded magnificently.

Don't trust the Indian media

<http://presstalk.blogspot.com/2005/10/ponytail-and-legal-notice.html>

The Ponytail And The Legal Notice!

Really like Desipundit, not only because they have brought a whole lot of new readers to this site—even though few of those new readers leave comments—but also because these guys can sometimes uncover some gems of hilarity from the Indian blogosphere. Blogger Gaurav Sabnis has been served a legal notice by the ponytailed management (maybe) guru (joke) Arindam Chaudhari. Now, I know giving space to this person is a waste of server space. But this letter is too hilarious! *Digit note: The letter—at the Blogspot page mentioned above—is worth a read!*

Vantage Point

<http://gauravsabnis.blogspot.com/2005/10/update.html>

An Update

I have resigned from IBM.

I got a call from a Senior Executive of Lenovo. Apparently, IIPM called him up, complaining about my posts... The next day, I got a call from him again. Apparently, the Dean of IIPM wrote him a mail saying that the IIPM Students Union had decided that if my blog posts were not deleted, then they would gather all the Thinkpads they had been given by the institute, and burn them in front of the IBM office in Delhi. Yes, that's right. Burn laptops!